



Student Media Board Constitution

All organizations that produce or intend to produce at least one form of mass media for the consumption of Furman's students, staff, or employees must be members of the Student Media Board (Board).

The Board functions as a means of bringing student concerns to the attention of the faculty and University authorities, of helping the University community formulate opinion on various campus and off-campus issues, and of providing a forum for debate. The student communications media will operate free of censorship

Because Furman University may have to bear the legal responsibilities for the contents of the publications, certain policies are considered inherent in the editorial freedom granted to student editors and managers. These policies include, but are not limited to, the following:

1. Avoidance of publication of statements of libel, indecency, undocumented allegations, harassing statements, the use of innuendo and attacks on personal integrity.
2. Observation of any applicable regulations of the Federal Communications Commission.
3. A show of regard for Furman University standards, philosophies and objectives.
4. A statement on all materials that members of the Board are student-run organizations and editorially independent, that these organizations benefit the campus of Furman University and the Greenville area, and that any opinions do not necessarily reflect the opinion of Furman University or any representatives of Furman.

ARTICLE 1

- 1.1** The name of this organization shall be the Furman University Student Media Board, referred to below as the Board.
- 1.2** For the purposes of this constitution, the word "Editor" shall refer to the editors of the student newspaper, yearbook or literary publication and the managers for the television and radio stations or any future or successive organizations.
- 1.3** The Board shall be responsible to the Vice President for Student Life or his/her designee (Board Advisor) for the solvency of media and for their service to the college community as a whole. The Board Advisor shall be responsible for organizing and chairing Board meetings, advising on constitutional or policy matters, for monitoring and authorizing expenditures, for the maintenance of the liability insurance coverage for the Board (if any), and for the Board's conformity to this constitution any and all University policies. The Board Advisor does not review or make any decisions on the content of the Board's mass media.

1.4 The Board shall be composed of:

- 1.4.1** The Vice President for Student Life or his/her designee (Board Advisor);
- 1.4.2** One Editor of each organization; and
- 1.4.3** The faculty/staff organizational advisor(s) for each media organization.

1.5 The authority of all Furman student media shall be vested in the Board, and shall extend to those media organizations recognized by the Board. Any publication that would be considered Furman student media must apply and be admitted to the Board to be produced and distributed on campus for the student body. Mass production of Furman student media through college facilities outside of the Board is subject to removal and may be required to cease publication. This rule, however, does not apply to media under the umbrella of other student organizations.

1.6 The Board shall be responsible for overseeing the individual media organizations that compose the Board, for acting as a liaison between the administration and the media organizations, for providing funding to the organizations, for reviewing unresolved complaints, for reviewing staff policy and procedures, for setting overall guidelines for the media organizations, for making capital equipment purchases, and for removing Editors who do not fulfill their responsibilities.

1.7 The Board shall meet at least once each semester during the academic year unless notified to the contrary by the Board Advisor. Special meetings may be called by the Board Advisor or by any two members of the Board.

1.8 If the scheduled meeting time of the Board is inconvenient for any Editor and no time can be found to accommodate all of the members of the Board, he/she may appoint a designee to serve as a voting representative in his/her place. The Board determines the competency of this designee and can, upon a majority vote, remove the designee from the Board, in which case the Editor must find a more suitable designee or begin to attend meetings himself/herself.

1.9 Each Editor on the Board shall have one vote, unless a member is acting as a designee for another member who has an excused absence for that particular meeting. No person may hold two positions on the Board simultaneously or have more than one vote. Media organizations coordinated by more than one editor will exercise one vote among them. The Board Advisor shall only vote to break a tie. Faculty/staff organizational advisors do not have votes but may take part in discussions.

1.10 The Board may invite other individuals to attend its meetings, but they may not vote. Except by invitation, Board meetings are closed.

1.11 A majority of the voting members of the Board must be present in order to conduct business.

- 1.12** Any Editor may be removed at the discretion of the Board, upon recommendation of the Board Advisor. Funding may also be removed from the publication for a period of time at the discretion of the Board. If a student member is being considered for removal from the Board, (s)he must receive a written notice of this matter prior to the next meeting. There is no recourse for actions taken by the Board. A three-quarters majority vote is required to remove any student member of the Board as well as to remove funding. All vacancies will be filled using the Editor Selection process outlined in this constitution.
- 1.13** Selection of new Editors occurs in the spring semester of the academic year. The selection is made by majority vote of the outgoing Editor (unless removed by the Board), the Board Advisor, and the faculty/staff organizational advisor.
- 1.14** In order to maintain editorial independence, organizations belonging to the Board are not eligible to receive funding from the Student Government Fee; instead, the Board receives set funds annually from Student Life's operating budget to be used at the discretion of the Editor and in accordance with this constitution.
- 1.15** Funds from the Board may not be used to purchase equipment, services, or other property for a Furman office or department without notice to the Board of the planned purchase and approval by the Board Advisor.
- 1.16** Any alterations to organizational funds require a three-quarters majority vote.
- 1.17** Any publication or media production wishing to become recognized by the University must first apply to the Board. Applications for a new organization will be accepted according to the following guidelines:
- 1.17.1** The proposed organization's ability to provide a service or forum that existing organizations do not;
 - 1.17.2** An affirmative statement that the proposed organization will agree to include in all publications and/or broadcast a statement that the views and opinions are those of the authors and do not necessarily reflect the opinion of Furman University or its official representatives.
 - 1.17.3** Support for the proposed organization from the student body, which can be demonstrated by an active membership roster that includes at least 10 non-senior/graduating students;
 - 1.17.4** Name, title, and contact information of university faculty/staff serving an organization advisor(s);
 - 1.17.5** A constitution following the template provided by SGA; and
 - 1.17.6** Availability of funds from the Board.

All organizations approved by the Board shall be placed on probationary status for a minimum of one year. While on probation, the publication shall have a non-voting representative attend all Board meetings. After the organization has published and/or broadcast at least twice as a probationary organization, it may move to be considered a permanent media organization of Furman University. The organization will be admitted to

the Board upon receiving approval of a majority of the voting members of the Board. Any organization already on permanent or probationary status shall receive preferential funding over newly proposed media organizations. Should a proposed organization fail to adhere to the above guidelines and/or fail to fulfill the details outlined in its proposal, upon a majority vote of the Board, probationary status shall be revoked, and the organization may only choose to request funding on a proposal basis with no preference over any other media organization.

- 1.18** An organization belonging to the Board will be removed and considered inactive if no Editor is selected, no media of any discernable quality is produced, or no money is spent from its budget for two consecutive years. Removing an organization earlier for inactivity requires a three-quarters majority vote by the Board.
- 1.19** Alternations to this constitution require a three-quarters majority vote by the Board.